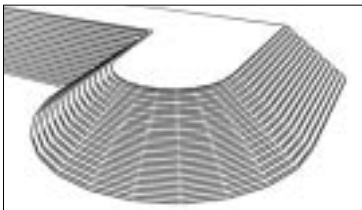


The surface we'll be using for more drag-and-cut madness



Tada! Grand entrances created in a flash!

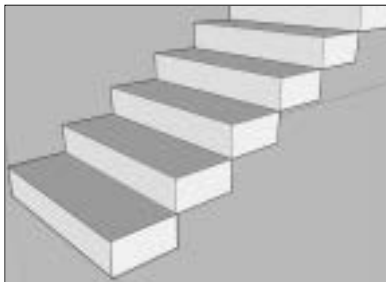
the upper section (the part you want to do away with) and drag your cursor along the top edge of the surface. If you're doing this right, you ought to end up with a rather interesting result.

Finally, we come to the most important, most flexible, and comparatively more challenging method.

4.2.3 The Component Method

In this method, we'll work on a single step, and then duplicate that step several times. This may sound iffy, but thanks to one wonderful feature of components, is quite handy. When you create duplicates of a component, any change you make to one automatically gets reflected in all the duplicates. What this means is that you can work on just one step and give it as much detail as you'd like—even after you've created the stairway.

Start with one single box. Use the Select tool ([Space]) and triple-click on it to select all the faces and edges. Right-click and choose Make Component. Call it Step. Now, using the same method as the Drag-and-cut method, make several duplicates of this box to form a stairway.



A pretty normal-looking stairway so far

Nothing remarkable yet, but it gets better. We want to create a little bulge (called a *nosing*) at the top-front of each step now, so let's get started. Double-click a step to go into Edit Component mode. Draw a line a little below the front edge, and use the Push tool to make that face jut out a bit.